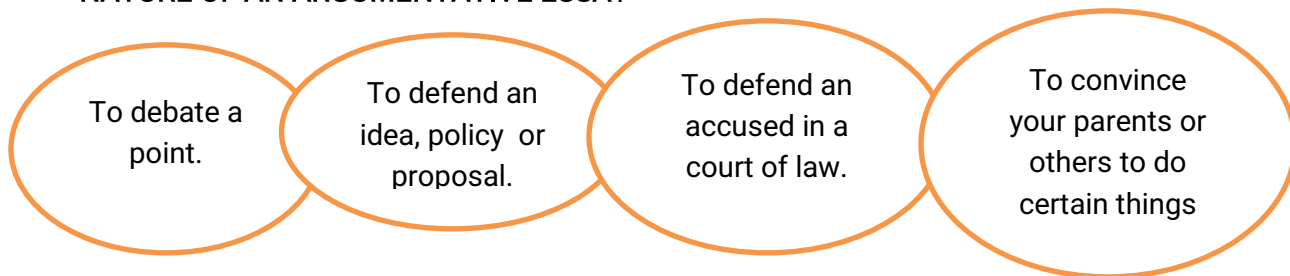


ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY

DEFINITION

Argumentative writing is a type of essay in which the writer attempts to make the reader or audience accept his views as a valid option. It can also be defined as a type of writing that involves expression of one's independent views or opinion on a topic that has been opened to a debate.

NATURE OF AN ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY



SIDES TO EVERY ARGUMENT

There are two sides to every argument.

1. The **Proposition** which is the side to argue in favour or support of a given topic.
2. The **Opposition** which is the side to present opinion against the topic.

FEATURES OF AN ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY.

- A) It requires no topic.

The motion moved represents the topic and the speaker's interest.(speak for or against).

B) INTRODUCTION

For instance, in a school setting, one can have the following introduction :

The Principal, Vice Principal, members of Staff, invited guests, panel of Judges, accurate time keeper, co debaters and fellow students. I am here to speak against the motion which states that.....

C) Body of the Essay.

This is a focus to back up points for your motion. E.g. provision of infrastructural facilities,



promotion of games, etc. in short, you must support or oppose with valid reasons and figures if need be.

- The use of apt words i.e relevant registers or vocabularies and phrases as the case may be is very important. Whichever stand you intend to take, the use of persuasion is very important.
- There must be clarity of argument.
- There must be logical presentation of ideas or points. That is, the essay must be well organized to attract valuable marks from the examiner.

D) Conclusion:

In concluding this type of essay, reference must be made to your listeners while giving a summary of all your points. A typical conclusion may end like this:

The Principal, Vice Principal, Panel of Judges, Ladies and Gentlemen and my Listeners, I hope you will all agree with my logical presentation of views that

MORE TECHNIQUES

- Audience inclusion
- Alliteration
- Acknowledging the opposing view..... then showing that it is wrong'
- Use powerful language to really get your point across.
- Use a variety of sentence types and lengths.

